Thamesmead Newsletter
June 2018



Peabody's plan for Thamesmead

Next month it will be 50 years since the first families moved into Thamesmead. Since then a lot has happened in London's 'New Town' and now some 45,000 people call the area home.

There's now opportunity to build 20,000 much-needed new homes and thousands of new jobs to go with them. These are in addition to new leisure, cultural and commercial facilities right here in Thamesmead.

Peabody is not just another housing developer. Inspired by philanthropist George Peabody's mission to provide safe and affordable housing for the working poor of Victorian London, today's organisation helps people make the most of their lives by providing good quality affordable homes, working with communities and promoting wellbeing.

This means Peabody is well-placed to deliver the changes needed in Thamesmead. It has 150 years of experience, all focused on putting the most vulnerable first, and building and looking after neighbourhoods that people want to live in.

Peabody is taking a 'whole place' philosophy to Thamesmead, ensuring a lasting contribution to the physical, environmental, cultural and economic wellbeing of the area.

The Elizabeth Line will start running from Abbey Wood this December, and there are plans to extend the DLR too. This means Thamesmead will soon be very well-connected to the City and the West End. Yet it will retain its own cultural vibe, whilst being a tranquil escape from the hustle and bustle of central London.

It all adds up to very exciting times for Thamesmead. Peabody is set to deliver over £1 billion of significant improvements to housing, green spaces, waterways and economic prosperity. And of course, encourage a thriving artistic and cultural scene in Thamesmead.

There is every opportunity for you to engage with this exciting and innovative process, and ensure your views are understood and recognised.

A simple way to start is to pop into Peabody's Information Hub at 216 Yarnton Way DA18 4AX, where you can view a scale model of the entire town, learn more about Peabody's exciting 'whole place' philosophy for Thamesmead, and how you can get involved in shaping your neighbourhood's future.

If Thamesmead is a part of the world you call home, please pop in and say hello. The Hub is open from 11am - 4pm every Tuesday and Wednesday and the first Saturday of every month.

Southmere update

The first phase of the Southmere development will deliver 130 new affordable homes. Our contractor, Durkan, have been on site since March.

Deep excavation pits are being dug, so new safety hoarding has been erected all around the site. Also, new double yellow lines have been painted so that emergency vehicles can still access people's homes quickly and easily. This has required some changes to the parking arrangements, and we would like to thank residents for the patience and assistance they have shown.

Ground surveys, and surveys of the lake and culvert (a tunnel carrying water) are under underway. Following completion of these in the summer, there will be some further 'enabling works' before Durkan start actual construction.

If you have any questions about the works please contact Sonia Allen at Durkan. She is available Monday to Friday from 8am to 5pm. You can contact Sonia on: 07775 664900 or by email at: sonia.allen@durkan.co.uk

Keeping Thamesmead active

Whatever your age, there's strong scientific evidence that being physically active can help you lead a healthier and even happier life. That's why we provide low cost, high quality services to engage people of all ages in sports and physical activity.

Last year 640 children, across six local schools, took part in the Thamesmead Primary School's 'keepy-uppy' football challenge. We'll be running this hugely popular Sports Relief event again this year.

In fact, over the last four years 3,100 people have taken part in over 48,000 hours of activity sessions locally. We will continue to provide low-cost activities in Thamesmead, so please keep an eye on our website for a brand new activity programme which will launch in July.

Chrissie, a local resident, said "I started coming along to sessions about 18 months ago. The sessions have improved my fitness, motivation and given me a zest for life. I have lost over three stone, completed the London to Brighton cycle ride along with completion of several 5k runs! It's all made a huge impact on my well-being."

For further information please contact Sporting Club Thamesmead, contact@sportingclubthamesmead.co.uk or call 0203 828 4920.

New fitness offer
£3 per session, £15 per month or £35 for 3 months
Visit our website for the latest timetable:
www.nttthamesmead.co.uk

Get involved in our summer holiday activities

We're planning an action-packed programme of summer activities for children, young people and families in Thamesmead. There will be various sporting activities, cookery sessions, cycling, indoor climbing and some coach day-trips. We'll also be running some community café events at Birchmere Community Hub off Disraeli Close where families can come along, eat nutritious food and take part in other activities. Look out for postcards promoting the programme distributed in school bags at the end of term. The full timetable of summer holiday activities will be on our website from July www.thamesmeadnow.org.uk

We also ran a very successful Easter activities programme and we had lots of local children and young people tell us about the sorts of activities they would like to see in our summer programme. Thank you to those who gave us feedback. It's been very helpful and we've been able to add many of your ideas into our summer programme. If you have suggestions about what you'd like to see happening in Thamesmead during the school holidays, or if you have questions about the summer holiday programme, please contact Christine Carrasco on Christine.carrasco@peabody.org.uk or call 020 3828 4683.

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Come and visit us!

The Information Hub, at 216 Yarnton Way, DA19 4DR, is open 11am-4pm every Tuesday and Wednesday and the first Saturday of every month for anybody to drop in to find out about our regeneration plans, community events and all things Thamesmead. We welcome questions, comments or suggestions. June is also the last month of the current exhibition which is showing archival photos to celebrate the first 50 years of Thamesmead. There will be a brand-new exhibition showing in July, please keep an eye on our website for details. So please do drop in, we would love to see you. If you would like more information or have any queries please contact: Sarah-Jane Day – Thamesmead Information Manager, Thamesmead. regen@peabody.org.uk or 020 3828 3671.



What's on

June

Sports Coaching and Leadership Traineeship
June – September
30 hours per week, 16-19Yrs
8 - 12 week unpaid work placement in sports coaching and leadership for young people.
Contact Dan Wells, 020 3828 4920 or Dan.wells@peabody.org.uk



Primary School Football Tournament
14 June
2.00 - 5:30pm
Location Sporting Club Thamesmead
The Matthew Clarke Football Memorial Tournament is held in memory of Matthew, a former pupil of St John Fisher primary school pupil and a Thamesmead Town Football Club under-10s team member who sadly passed away 21 years ago from Leukaemia. The tournament is thought to be the longest running annual football memorial in both the London Borough of Bexley and the Royal Borough of Greenwich.
Contact Dan Wells, 020 3828 4920 or Dan.wells@peabody.org.uk



Fly by Night

As part of Thamesmead's 50th anniversary, Peabody is hosting this extraordinary performance which pays homage to the crucial role that pigeons played during the First World War, and celebrates the important heritage of Thamesmead as part of the Royal Arsenal.

At dusk, a large flock of pigeons will fly in formation over the river Thames carrying LED lights where they once would have carried vital messages. This will be a unique and unmissable performance, celebrating our local history like never before.



FREE tickets available to Thamesmead residents for an exclusive performance on 20 June. Up to 4 free tickets per customer.

Please book asap to secure your place. **www.liftfestival.com/events/fly-by-night-exclusive-performance**
Other performance dates: 21 – 23 June
Time: 9.15pm

Location Former golf course, East Thamesmead

Contact Tickets from £7.50
Buy online at liftfestival.com

Getting there
There is no car parking facility on site and all audience members are encouraged to arrive by public transport.

Audience members with additional access requirements should contact LIFT on 020 7968 6808 to ensure a car parking space – these are offered on a first come, first served basis. It is highly recommended that anyone with mobility issues use the allocated viewing area, as the general audience area has uneven flooring.

Health Checks and Management Workshop
26 June
6.00pm – 8.30pm
No cost
Location Sporting Club Thamesmead
Workshops to help community groups and small organisations recruit and manage volunteers.
Contact Georgia Mann, 0203 828 3948 or Georgia.mann@peabody.org.uk

July

First Waves: Exploring the impact of race relations legislation in the UK
Workshops on 3, 7, 10 and 11 July
Artist Scarlett Crawford has been appointed by the UK Parliament for a new project to explore and celebrate the 1965, 1968 and 1976 Race Relations Acts. Over the course of the year Scarlett will be working with communities across the country – including residents in Thamesmead – to create artworks with local people through a series of workshops and activities, exploring race relations and what it has meant to them.
To get involved please contact lisa.drew@peabody.org.uk

Policies and Procedures Workshop
2 July
6.00pm – 8.30pm
No cost
Location Sporting Club Thamesmead
Training course for volunteers / small community groups.
Contact Georgia Mann, 0203 828 3948 or Georgia.mann@peabody.org.uk



Beautiful Thing performance

3 -7 July
9.45pm
South Thamesmead
Contact Thamesmead residents can book free tickets to a 'Beautiful Thing' via https://festival.org/whats-on/beautiful-thing/

This iconic, optimistic love story about teenage boys Jamie and Ste is given a homecoming in this unique outdoor production of Jonathan Harvey's well loved play, A Beautiful Thing. The outdoor live performance, will be part

of Greenwich and Docklands Festival finale, will take place on and around the original South Thamesmead locations where the play (and 1996 Channel Four film) were set, marking the 50th anniversary of the first families moving in to this riverside community. The new dance-theatre production, capturing the urban realism and fairytale fantasy of Harvey's script, is narrated by the fabulous, ukulele-wielding troubadour Lord Hicks and features stunning digital projections by NOVAK, new music by Roma Yagnik and a community chorus.

All performances have captions; Saturday's performance will be audio described and preceded by a touch tour at 8.45pm. Email elizabeth@festival.org to book a place.

Beautiful Thing is co-directed by Bradley Hemmings and Robby Graham.

Supported by Peabody and the Royal Borough of Greenwich.

Monthly cinema - Beasts of the Southern Wild (12+)

7 July
3.30pm
The Link, Bazalgette Way, Off Harrow Manor Way, Thamesmead, SE2 9BS
Tickets: Adults £2, children £1 and under 5s free. Please feel free to bring your own food and drink. Join us for a family friendly matinee once a month at The Link showing all the old favorites. All profits go into future film screenings.



Thamesmead Children's Charter

12 July
No cost
Various school locations
Launch of Thamesmead Children's Charter. All school age children
Contact Gez Kellaghan on 0203 828 4909 or gez.kellaghan@peabody.org.uk

Thamesmead 50th Birthday Festival

14 July
Around Southmere Lake
The much-loved Thamesmead Festival returns to the iconic shores of Southmere Lake on the 14 July. And this year London's New Town celebrates a rather special birthday as it turns 50. The fun-packed, one-day festival will showcase exceptional local talent, great music and will be a truly spectacular community carnival and plenty of delicious food and drink. Bring all the family and enjoy a great day out in Thamesmead.

Holiday Activity Programme – Football Course

23 – 27 July
10:00am-3:00pm
£39 for the week
A week-long football course including small-sided games, fun coaching drills and tournaments. Must be 5-12Yrs.
Sporting Club Thamesmead
Contact Ali Egal, 020 38284920 or Ali.Egal@peabody.org.uk

Afternoon tea and dance for older people

23 July 2018
2pm
Free
If you're over 60 and fancy an afternoon of music and entertainment then come along and have some fun. Afternoon will be served. Transport may also be available so please get in touch.
Lakeview Court, Central Way, Thamesmead, London, SE28 8GL
Contact Daniel Browne on 0203 828 3888 or 07710 916735 or email daniel.browne@peabody.org.uk

Family Cookery Sessions

25 July, 1 August, 8 August, 15 August, 22 August and 29 August
10:30am – 1pm
No cost
Learn how make your own healthy and taster meals for the whole family! All ages welcome. Booking required
Contact Stephanie Turner, 0203 828 4925 or Stephanie.Turner@peabody.org.uk

Holiday Activity Programme – Football Course

30 July – 3 August
10:00am-3:00pm
£39 for the week
A week-long football course including small-sided games, fun coaching drills and tournaments. Must be 5-12Yrs.
Sporting Club Thamesmead
Contact Ali Egal, 020 38284920 or Ali.Egal@peabody.org.uk

Family Cycling Course

30 July – 2 August
No cost
A fun-packed family cycling course for all ages. Bikes and helmets are provided however encouraged to bring if possible. Booking is essential.
Contact Stephanie Turner, 0203 828 4925 or Stephanie.Turner@peabody.org.uk

Contact us

Online www.ThamesmeadNow.org.uk
Email Thamesmead.Regen@peabody.org.uk
Phone 0300 123 1237

Visit us

The Information Hub
216 Yarnton Way, DA18 4AX
Open from 11am - 4pm every Tuesday and Wednesday and the first Saturday of every month

Find out what's happening across Thamesmead

Sign up to the Thamesmead e-newsletter. All you have to do is email ThamesmeadNow@Peabody.org.uk adding 'Sign me up' in the subject line.

www.ThamesmeadNow.org.uk
ThamesmeadNow
ThamesmeadLDN

Nature on your doorstep

There is about 150 hectares of parkland, nature reserves and waterways in Thamesmead. That's more space than Kensington Gardens, Hyde Park, Green Park and St James's Park put together. The scale, extent and variety of landscape at Thamesmead has always been part of its appeal.

Regenerating the area isn't only about providing new good quality affordable homes. Peabody are placing as much emphasis on building attractive neighbourhoods, and this includes looking after significant areas of parks and open spaces.

Over the years some areas have been managed less intensively and now appear over-mature and relatively neglected. This is particularly evident in areas set aside for wildlife and the network of canals, lakes and wetlands.

Peabody's will collaborate with some of the best names in `green and blue architecture' to protect and enhance the landscape so that it works better, is more connected and more productive. This way Peabody will transform Thamesmead into one of London's most bio-diverse and sustainable urban living environments.

No other area of London can match Thamesmead for green spaces, lakes and waterways. Long-term investment and management of this great natural resource will provide an opportunity to live surrounded by nature at a scale rarely enjoyed elsewhere in capital.

Of course, there are already lakes, open spaces and nature reserves that can be enjoyed right now. So, with summer around the corner why not get your waking boots on and enjoy the great outdoors right here in Thamesmead.

Barge Pole update

The building, which was previously the Barge Pole public house, will be demolished during July and August to make way for the Harrow Manor Way improvement scheme. During this period the footpath beside the Barge Pole will be closed and the adjoining car park will be used as a site compound.

New art design and lighting for Moorings underpass

Students from the Woolwich Polytechnic and young people from Hawksmoor Youth Club are working together to create a new art and lighting design to transform an underpass between Arnott Close and Claridge Way in the Moorings. The students, working with local Thamesmead artist Sam Skinner, are aiming to make the underpass feel welcoming with their vibrant art design and safer will new lighting.

The students have developed their design concepts through a series of workshops and study visits with final concepts to be agreed early June. With the help of lighting designers, Light Follows Behaviour, and ceramists, The Grantchester Pottery, the year 7 students and young people have researched pattern techniques, architecture, lighting and materials. The idea for the project is that patterned tiles will be fixed to the underpass wall and the new lighting will brighten up the area and waterway.

It is expected that the underpass will complete its transformation later this year. The project is part of a series of improvement projects planned for the Moorings area by Peabody working collaboratively with the local community.
To find out more or if you would like to get involved in future projects in the Moorings please contact Lukas.holden@peabody.org.uk

Photo 1 The current underpass
Photo 2 Young people from Hawksmoor Youth Club on a visit to Kings Cross to explore how creative lighting can be used to make an area more welcoming


1




2

50 1968–2018 Thamesmead

Thamesmead 50th Birthday Festival 14 July 2018/ 12-7pm Around Southmere Lake

Come and celebrate

Thamesmead's 50th birthday at an all-day family day out around Southmere Lake.

The Gooch family were the first to move to Thamesmead 50 years ago with the location of the festival, Southmere Lake, chosen because of its close proximity to their family home.

What's on and where

Community market
Delicious food from all over the world at the craft market on Southmere Square with exciting handmade things to buy - all made by our local businesses.

Carnival time!
Setting off from Bishop John Robinson School in north Thamesmead and making its way to South Thamesmead this year's carnival will consist of five themes to represent what is special about Thamesmead. School from across Thamesmead will be taking part.

The carnival performances include:

- TARU Brazilian carnival drumming collective
- Tropical Mas carnival dancers
- Odubuwa talking drummers
- Cultural groups from across Thamesmead

If you would like to join the parade, please email **takingpart@eea.org.uk**

Step right up and come to the circus!
The circus arena with Albert & Friends Instant Circus will be putting on incredible hourly aerial displays and circus workshops in between so you can have a go too!

Current mainstage line up showcasing the very best Thamesmead talent

- The vine choir – gorgeous gospel
- Jecoliah & Jerusha Frimpong – Thamesmead based soul duo
- Thamesmead homegrown star Kid Bookie and much more!

Pet show – showcasing all creatures great and small
After popular demand the Pet show is back so please bring your pet along, the more unusual the better!

Time to boogie in our dance arena!

- Dynamixx – street dance from Thamesmead's best loved dance group
- Danzability – making dance accessible for all
- Elsa Perez – ex latin ballroom star leads the tea dance on Southmere Square

Plus much more…

- Community Music & their sound jams!
- Bouncy castle
- Dinghy racing! With the Thamesmead YMCA sailing club
- The WI tea parlour – homemade cakes and teas from Abbey Wood's women's institute plus much more

Special thanks to the steering group of 11 local residents from across Thamesmead, who have volunteered their time to bring you a great day out.

Calling all volunteers!
If you would like to help on the day please email lisa.drew@peabody.org.uk

